Day 76 - Inland

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 97 · Lion's Head Provincial Nature Reserve

13.7 km / 8.5 mi	~5.0 h	2.3 km new	203 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Parking area outside the Lion's Head Provincial Nature Reserve gate, accessible from Bruce County Rd 9 via Evergreen Rd or Cemetery Rd, just north of Barrow Bay. Google Maps. **Free · book ahead**

Side trails covered: Inland Side Trail (2.3 km)

Navigate: import *day76_hike097.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** The lot outside the reserve gate (via Evergreen Rd or Cemetery Rd) has only a few spots, so arrive early.
- **Cemetery Road & Ilse Hanel Side Trails:** These lead from the parking to the main trail. The Ilse Hanel Side Trail is blue-blazed and is part of the reserve's perimeter loop. No detailed terrain descriptions were found.
- **Main Bruce Trail (escarpment edge):** The main trail around the reserve often runs very close to the cliff edge. Expect technical rock, glacial potholes on the clifftop, ancient white cedars and big Georgian Bay lookouts. Keep Zappy close at the edge and go when it's dry if you can.
- **Inland Side Trail:** A 2.3 km stretch through the interior of the reserve, away from the cliffs. Inland, the reserve is known for wildflower-rich woodland and karst landforms.
- **Facilities:** There are no visitor facilities in the reserve, so bring water for you and Zappy.
- **Inland & Geodetic Side Trails:** Short blue-blazed trails into the reserve's interior, which has wildflower-rich woodland and karst landforms. The Geodetic spur is only 0.1 km long. No other details were found.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Parking area outside the Lion's Head Provincial Nature Reserve gate, accessible from.... Head north on the blue-blazed Cemetery Road Side Trail.
0.4	0.3	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail goes off on your left.)
0.4	0.3	Heads-up: The next 0.0 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.6	0.3	Heads-up: The next 0.0 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.6	0.4	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).

0.9	0.6	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
4.6	2.9	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Inland Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
6.9	4.3	J4: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
9.1	5.7	J3: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
12.8	8.0	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
13.0	8.1	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
13.1	8.2	Heads-up: The next 0.0 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
13.2	8.2	Heads-up: The next 0.0 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
13.3	8.3	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Cemetery Road Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail goes off on your right.)
13.7	8.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Fastest Known Time route page, the Ontario Parks trail map and the Great Lakes Sea Kayaking Association.